

first, he brought me in to work with inStream Solutions, an independent financial planning software company he developed for advisory firms when he was not satisfied with any of the existing financial planning software available for financial advisors. The software can dramatically improve the efficiency of financial advisors and help ensure that all of their clients' financial plans are updated and monitored on a daily basis.

Though inStream is fully independent of McLean, I worked and still work as director of retirement research at the company, having helped build a safe savings rate module, create distribution rules to guide retirement withdrawals, develop ways to compare financial plans with metrics going beyond the simple probability of failure, build reasonable capital market assumptions to guide the Monte Carlo simulations, and implement a Social Security calculator.

As I worked with inStream, I learned more about McLean and came to understand that McLean is a fee-only fiduciary firm that truly understands the retirement income problem. They understand the need to build efficient retirement income strategies that may reduce assets managed in the short term but will help their clients the most in the long term. McLean also shares my interest in education, as Alex holds a PhD himself. In 2014, I joined McLean Asset Management as a principal at the firm. Working with McLean provides the resources to strengthen my Retirement Researcher website and help get my message out to a wider audience, with an understanding that education is the primary goal.

Retirement Researcher

I created my Retirement Researcher blog in September 2010. As my blog has developed over the years, I have still tried to maintain the original mission stated on earlier versions of the site: RetirementResearcher.com provides independent, data-driven, and research-based information about retirement income planning. The website is geared toward providing unbiased information about building efficient retirement income strategies and is willing to cross between the various silos of the financial services profession. I outlined in chapter 1 how there are two completely different schools of thought about retirement income planning: the probability-based